5, 2007, the Writers Guild of America called a strike. Jonah was forbidden to continue writing, and disappeared.

I panicked. Will all our hard work, all our dreams, be for naught? I asked Lynda. She counseled patience, but was clearly very upset. She vividly tells the story of the strike in scene 6 of her book *Sleepless in Hollywood*. The scene is titled “The Catastrophe.”

The strike lasted three months. On February 12, when it ended, Jonah returned to writing and to intense discussions with Lynda and me. Over the next sixteen months, he produced a long, detailed outline for the screenplay, and then three successive drafts of the screenplay itself. When each was finished, we met with Steven to discuss it. Steven would ask probing questions for an hour or more before proffering suggestions, requests, or instructions for changes. He was not very hands-on, but he was thoughtful, incisive, creative—and sometimes firm.

In June 2009, Jonah gave Steven draft 3 of the screenplay, and disappeared from the scene. He had long ago committed to write *The Dark Knight Rises*, and had been delaying for month after month while working on *Interstellar*. He could delay no more, and we were without a screenwriter. On top of that, Jonah’s father became gravely ill. Jonah spent many months in London by his father’s side, until his father’s death in December. Through this long hiatus, I feared that Steven would lose interest.

But Steven hung in there with us, awaiting Jonah’s return. He and Lynda could have hired somebody else to complete the screenplay, but they so valued Jonah’s talents that they waited.

Finally in February 2010 Jonah was back, and on March 3, Steven, Lynda, Jonah, and I had a very productive meeting to discuss Jonah’s nine-month-old draft 3. I was feeling a bit giddy. At last we were back on track.